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FREE WORKBOOK · 2026 EDITION

Online Store Launch Toolkit for Beginners

Starting an online store in Nigeria does not have to feel overwhelming. With the right toolkit and a step-by-step plan, you can launch with confidence. Here is everything you need to...



7 pages · PDF

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Starting an online store in Nigeria does not have to feel overwhelming. With the right toolkit and a step-by-step plan, you can launch with confidence. Here is everything you need to get started.

01 Phase 1: Foundation Setup (Week 1-2)

Choose your platform. Pick something simple that works well on a phone. Options include WooCommerce, Shopify (billed in US dollars) or Shopinbos, where Rex, the AI store builder, builds your store with payments and delivery already included. Shopinbos is free to start; see shopinbos.com/pricing.

Secure your domain. Pick a name that is easy to remember. A `.ng` or `.com.ng` ending shows you are a Nigerian business, and local registrars like Whogohost sell them in naira. Keep it short, easy to spell and without hyphens. Budget roughly ₦5,000 to ₦25,000 a year.

Essential legal setup

- Register with the CAC: a business name is cheaper and quicker; a limited company gives more protection
- Get a TIN (Tax Identification Number). It is free
- Open a business bank account in your business name. Your bank will ask for your BVN
- Consider basic insurance for your stock

02 Phase 2: Store Design and Content (Week 3-4)

Design your store. Most customers shop on Android phones, so choose a clean theme that looks good on a small screen. Focus on:

- A clear menu (for example: Women, Men, Hair, Gadgets)
- A professional logo (use Canva for free designs)
- The same colours on your store, Instagram and WhatsApp
- Bright product photos taken in daylight on a plain background

Write product descriptions that sell. Include what customers always ask: size, material, colour, care and delivery time. Use bullet points for easy reading. Always say what problem the product solves.

Create essential pages

- About Us (who you are and where you are based builds trust)
- Delivery and Returns Policy (areas, timelines, who pays for returns)
- Privacy Policy (how you use customer details)
- Contact Information (WhatsApp number, phone, email and city)

03 Phase 3: Payment and Delivery Setup (Week 4)

Taking payments. Offer the options Nigerians actually use:

- Cards, bank transfer and USSD through Paystack or Flutterwave
- Direct bank transfer (confirm the money has landed before sending goods)
- Pay on delivery, starting with nearby areas
- PayPal only for customers abroad

Gateways charge a small fee per payment. Check current fees on their websites and include them in your prices.

Delivery plan. Start simple: a flat fee per city, or free delivery above a set amount (for example, free in Lagos on orders above ₦30,000). Use:

- Local dispatch riders for same-day delivery in your city
- Kwik Delivery for on-demand Lagos deliveries
- GIG Logistics for Abuja, Port Harcourt, Kano and other states
- Sendbox to compare and book carriers in one place
- DHL only for international orders

04 Phase 4: Marketing Preparation (Week 5)

Social media setup. Create business accounts on:

- WhatsApp Business (catalogue, quick replies, broadcasts)
- Instagram (fashion, beauty and anything visual)
- TikTok (short videos reach younger buyers)
- Facebook and Facebook Marketplace (wider reach)

Use the same name everywhere.

Collect contacts. Use WhatsApp broadcasts for quick updates and Mailchimp or Brevo for email. Send new contacts a welcome message and a small first-order discount.

Help people find you on Google

- Use words customers search for in product names (“ankara gown”, not “Style 004”)
- Write a unique description for every product
- Add a short text description to every image
- Create a free Google Business Profile

05 Essential Tools Toolkit

Free tools:

- Google Analytics (how many people visit)
- Google Search Console (what people searched to find you)
- Canva (graphics and social posts)
- Meta Business Suite (schedule Instagram and Facebook posts)

Paid tools worth considering later:

- Mailchimp or Brevo paid plans (billed in US dollars)
- Canva Pro for brand kits and background removal
- A separate data plan or MiFi for business

06 Launch Week Checklist

Before going live, test everything:

- Place a test order from start to finish
- Check all links work
- Make small real payments by card, transfer and USSD
- Test on an Android phone with slow data
- Check delivery fees for each city
- Double-check your contact details

07 Post-Launch Essentials (Week 6+)

Customer service setup. Decide how you will answer questions:

- WhatsApp Business with quick replies and away messages
- Peggy, the Shopinbos AI assistant, to help reply on WhatsApp and other chats
- A business email for complaints and formal questions

Numbers to check weekly:

- Store visitors
- Share of visitors who buy (your “conversion rate”)
- Average amount spent per order
- Ad spend needed to get one new customer

Keep improving. Collect feedback through:

- A WhatsApp message after delivery
- Product reviews
- Social media comments and DMs

08 Budget Planning

As an example, a small Nigerian online store might start with ₦100,000 to ₦400,000 for:

- Store platform (some are free to start)
- Domain name (₦5,000 to ₦25,000 a year)
- Logo and design (free on Canva, or a designer)
- CAC registration (check current fees on the CAC website)
- Starter ads (₦30,000 to ₦150,000)

09 Final Tips

Start small and grow step by step. You do not need every feature from day one. Focus on good products, honest delivery times and fast replies. Success comes from consistency, not perfection.

Every successful seller, from the Lagos fashion brand to the shea butter seller in Kano, started where you are now. Take it one step at a time. Your first sale will feel amazing, and it is only the beginning.

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Ready to make your first sale?

Rex builds your store with you in 5 minutes. Take card, transfer and pay on delivery, book riders, and let Peggy answer customers on WhatsApp.

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